

TORNBERG CONSULTING, LLC
DRAFT FOR REVIEW, COORDINATION, AND REVISION



TORNBERG INTELLIGENCE DIGEST

U.S. ELECTION-SECURITY RISK
KEY VULNERABILITIES, THREAT VECTORS,
AND ACTIONABLE ASSURANCE MEASURES

Executive digest of Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02

PUBLIC-SOURCE DRAFT | 18 JULY 2026

DRAFT STATUS

This document was generated with support of the Tornberg Analyst GPT, the Tornberg Consulting Methodology, and the Tornberg Consulting Analytic Framework. It has not been approved or released by Tornberg Consulting, LLC. The purpose of this draft is analytic review, coordination, and administrative review against analytic, tradecraft, and publication standards.

Bottom Line Up Front

The United States faces multiple distinct and demonstrably exploitable election-security threat vectors. The reviewed public record does not establish nationwide compromise of certified vote counts. It does establish that registration, eligibility, identity, mail-ballot, trusted-access, physical-custody, cyber, reporting, financial, and information pathways have been exploited, attempted, or credibly targeted. The principal exposure is uneven assurance: controls exist, but their coverage, performance, auditability, and detectability are not measured or enforced through one common national framework. [C-01; SP-01]

Principal judgment: the most practical near-term risk-reduction opportunity is to establish strong preventive assurance before any registration, ballot, user, software component, or election transaction enters an active process, then reinforce prevention with detection, containment, independent verification, and recovery. Preventing improper activation *and* preventing improper exclusion are coequal election-integrity requirements: eligibility controls should verify every legally material criterion before ordinary activation while preserving alternative evidence, secondary review, cure, appeal, and provisional participation when authoritative information is incomplete.

Priority Judgments

The following table distills the principal judgments from Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02, which examined 15 threat vectors affecting registration, eligibility, ballot access, trusted access, technology, physical custody, reporting, campaign finance, foreign influence, and systemic failure under the Tornberg Analytic Framework. Use this section to identify the judgments most likely to affect legislation, oversight, funding, standards, and implementation decisions. Confidence applies only to the bounded proposition stated.

#	Judgment	Confidence
1	Multiple vectors are real and warning-relevant. A validated instance establishes operational exploitability; it does not establish national prevalence, recurrence, coordination, or outcome effect.	HIGH
2	Pre-entry assurance is under-standardized. Registration and eligibility controls should test legally material criteria before ordinary activation while measuring improper activation and improper exclusion.	MOD-HIGH
3	Paper records are nearly universal, but paper availability is not outcome assurance. Audit design, custody, escalation, and certification practices remain uneven.	HIGH
4	Technology improves capacity and accessibility but creates concentration, credential, vendor, logging, software, and common-mode risk when the platform executing a function is also the only source of proof.	HIGH
5	Foreign actors can exploit voter data, authentic disputes, public uncertainty, domestic intermediaries, and reporting delays without altering a recorded vote. The PRC baseline supports collection and influence capability, not vote alteration.	MOD-HIGH
6	Current evidence cannot rank vectors by national frequency or undetected prevalence. The primary gap is how often vectors are attempted, when controls fail, what remains invisible, and how far exploitation can progress.	HIGH

Analytic rule

Do not compress stages. Vulnerability, attempt, access or transaction, acceptance, count or operational effect, certification effect, and outcome effect are separate propositions. A pathway reaching one stage is not evidence that it reached every later stage. [C-01; PSR-01]

Digest use note: This digest is designed for decision support during legislative, oversight, funding, standards, and implementation deliberations. Method and source details are preserved in the companion process summary and source packet. [PSR-01; SP-01]

Key Vulnerabilities Requiring Executive Attention

The following table identifies the cross-cutting vulnerabilities that allow multiple threat vectors to enter the election lifecycle, evade detection, or create unresolved uncertainty. These are control conditions rather than incident counts. Use the paired control objectives to test whether pending policy or implementation proposals reduce exposure, improve independent evidence, and preserve lawful voter access.

Vulnerability	Current condition	Control objective
Pre-entry uncertainty	No common national assurance outcome requires every legally material registration criterion to be supported before ordinary activation, with uniform alternative evidence and due-process protections.	Accurate, timely, reviewable eligibility determination that measures both improper activation and improper exclusion.
Independent verification gap	Paper evidence is widespread, but not every material outcome is verified by an audit independent of the initial tallying system.	Reconstruct material outcomes from evidence independent of the system producing the initial result.
Technology dependence	Some functions rely on platforms, vendors, credentials, software, and remote services whose logging, testing, change control, and fallback procedures are uneven.	No critical platform should be both executor and exclusive source of proof.
Fragmented detectability	Incident taxonomies, referrals, evidence retention, disposition tracking, and control-performance measures are not consistently comparable nationwide.	Standardize what is logged, reported, retained, investigated, and measured.
Data exposure	Voter and political data support administration but can enable targeting, identity misuse, coercion, surveillance, influence, and false evidence.	Minimize disclosure, control access, monitor use, and protect sensitive fields.
Communication latency	Delays, unexplained anomalies, and inconsistent public authentication create space for adversaries and domestic actors to exploit genuine uncertainty.	Authenticate official channels, pre-plan incident communications, and publish verified control outcomes.

Assessment

The principal systemic problem is uneven assurance and limited measurement across a decentralized environment, not evidence that all elections or certified counts are broadly compromised. Warning and mitigation remain justified without making the latter claim. [C-01]

Threat Vectors and Meaningful Metrics

The following table compresses the larger assessment's 15-vector register into six decision-relevant families. It shows the supported pathway, the most useful available metric or exposure anchor, the principal control emphasis, and the confidence boundary. Use it to distinguish an established vulnerability or exploitation pathway from an unsupported claim about national frequency, coordination, or outcome effect.

Family	Threat vector	Metric / anchor	Control emphasis	Confidence
Registration / list integrity	Duplicate, stale, inaccurate, or fraudulent records; false-registration exploitation.	234.5m eligible records; 103m+ registration transactions; 10.4m duplicate transactions, defined as exact-match submissions, not duplicate voting. [EAC-01]	Pre-entry validation; deduplication; provenance; notice/cure.	Existence HIGH / Scale-effect LOW
Eligibility exploitation	Ineligible registration or voting under applicable law; improper exclusion risk if validation is poorly designed.	% applications requiring secondary review; false-acceptance/rejection; cure/appeal/reversal.	Criterion validation; no single-database veto; provisional path.	Existence HIGH / Scale-effect LOW
Mail-ballot and ballot access	Forged, unauthorized, coerced, improperly returned, or misdirected ballots.	~30% of 158m+ ballots cast by mail; 585,457 entered cure; 270,753 rejected. [EAC-01]	Issue-return-accept-count reconciliation; custody; tracking.	Existence HIGH / Scale-effect LOW-MOD
Trusted access / physical custody	Misuse by officials, workers, vendors, or authorized actors; custody failure; ballot stuffing/destruction/disruption.	675,434 Election Day workers; 94,466 new among reported workforce; ~15m drop-box returns. [EAC-01]	Least privilege, MFA, two-person control, chain of custody.	Existence HIGH / Scale-effect LOW
Cyber / vendor / software	Compromise or failure of registration systems, pollbooks, election systems, vendors, reporting, and campaign infrastructure.	39.9% jurisdictions use e-pollbooks; track MFA/log coverage, remote access, hash variance, recovery time. [EAC-01; NIST-01]	Segmentation, software provenance, hash validation, independent logs, manual continuity.	Attempts HIGH / Count effect LOW
Reporting / certification / information	False reporting, canvass disruption, official impersonation, foreign and domestic influence, synthetic content, delayed correction.	Correction latency; unresolved discrepancies; reach; attributed campaigns; impersonated officials. [FMI-01; FMI-02]	Authenticated channels, pre-bunking, escalation rules, verified correction.	Info vector HIGH / Recurrence MOD-HIGH

Metrics are anchors for oversight and implementation. They are not national fraud rates unless a representative denominator, detection probability, disposition standard, and deduplication method are established. [SP-01]

Recommended Actions for Policy and Implementation Decisions

The following actions are the principal U.S.-controlled measures derived from the threat-vector, vulnerability, and assurance analysis. Each recommendation is traceable to a demonstrated pathway or material control gap and is framed as an outcome rather than a single mandated operating model. Use the table to assess legislative text, oversight requirements, grants, standards, and implementation sequencing; legal, fiscal, privacy, accessibility, federalism, and technical review remain necessary.

ID	Action	Purpose	Horizon
R-01	Establish an outcomes-based national election-assurance framework.	Define minimum evidence, control, metric, incident, audit, and continuity outcomes while permitting lawful state implementation paths.	0-18 months
R-02	Require pre-entry eligibility assurance with fair exception handling.	Verify legally material criteria before ordinary activation where lawful; provide alternative evidence, secondary review, cure, appeal, privacy protection, and provisional participation.	Immediate design; phased implementation
R-03	Make every material outcome independently reconstructable.	Require voter-verifiable paper evidence, complete ballot accounting, controlled custody, and preserved records sufficient for audit or recount independent of the original system.	Before certification
R-04	Adopt a common post-election outcome-audit standard.	Use risk-limiting audits or comparably defensible methods with escalation, correction, evidence, timing, and publication requirements.	1-2 cycles
R-05	Set minimum election-technology and vendor assurance controls.	Unique credentials, MFA, least privilege, two-person control, segmentation, software provenance, hash validation, restricted remote access, independent logging, backups, vendor incident duties.	Immediate for high-risk gaps; 12-24 months
R-06	Standardize incident, referral, and control-performance reporting.	Create taxonomy separating allegation, anomaly, attempt, control activation, verified exploitation, acceptance, count effect, disposition, and correction.	0-18 months
R-07	Reduce voter-data exposure and monitor authorized use.	Minimize fields, protect sensitive data, authenticate users, log access, limit vendors/data brokers, investigate anomalous use.	Immediate and continuing
R-08	Strengthen trusted-access and manual-continuity assurance.	Inventory privileged roles, require dual control, train and supervise temporary workers, exercise manual fallbacks and support.	Before each election
R-09	Institutionalize foreign-influence warning and authenticated communication.	Protect official channels, pre-bunk recurring narratives, monitor impersonation/hack-and-leak activity, coordinate attribution, publish verified outcomes.	Immediate and continuing
R-10	Create a controlled national evidence and disposition repository.	Maintain privacy-protected case, incident, control, audit, and final-disposition records to support trend analysis without converting allegations into findings.	12-36 months

Recommendations inform executive judgment. They require legal, fiscal, operational, privacy, accessibility, federalism, and technical review before adoption. [C-01; PSR-01]

Implementation Design: Prevent, Verify, and Preserve Access

This section provides the implementation logic behind the recommendations. A proposal should be tested across five layers - prevent, detect, contain or correct, independently verify, and recover or learn - because no single control can establish election assurance by itself. The same design must protect against both improper activation and improper exclusion.

Decision principle Standardize assurance outcomes and evidence requirements without assuming one centralized operating model is suitable for every jurisdiction. Use lawful federal, state, local, funding, certification, procurement, and voluntary-standard authorities as appropriate; identify where legislation or additional authority is required. [C-01]		
Layer	Control objective	Examples
Prevent	Stop invalid or unauthorized inputs before activation.	Criterion validation; application provenance; least privilege; software approval; custody design.
Detect	Identify attempts, errors, and control bypass.	Duplicate alerts; access logs; custody exceptions; software hashes; reporting variances; influence indicators.
Contain / correct	Limit spread, resolve records, preserve evidence.	Cure and appeal; cancellation/reissue; credential revocation; isolation; referral and case disposition.
Independently verify	Reconstruct process and outcome outside the originating system.	Human-readable ballots; complete ballot accounting; custody record; risk-limiting or equivalent audit; preserved logs.
Recover / learn	Restore lawful operations and remediate weaknesses.	Manual continuity, known-good restoration, after-action review, public correction, standards update.

Eligibility assurance must be fair to be secure

Before ordinary activation, registration systems should support identity, citizenship for federal elections, age, residence or domicile, jurisdiction, disqualification or restoration status, duplicate-active-record status, and application integrity under applicable law. A missing, stale, or conflicting database record should trigger resolution, not automatic rejection. Controls should include alternative evidence, specific notice and cure, secondary human review, appeal, provisional participation where legally available, privacy protections, accessibility, language support, and continuity procedures. [EAC-06; EAC-08; EAC-09; EAC-10; DOJ-03; USCIS-01; FVAP-01]

Immediate 2026 Priorities and Warning Indicators

The following priorities convert the assessment into near-term implementation and oversight tasks for the 2026 cycle. They focus on controls that can be measured before voting, during operations, and before certification. Use the indicators to determine whether a jurisdiction or program is ready, whether a control has failed, and when escalation, correction, or additional collection is required.

Priority	Implementation action	Metric / indicator
Close pre-entry gaps	Identify systems activating registrations without documented support for required criteria; implement fair secondary review and deadline-preserving fallback.	Validation coverage; unresolved duplicate-active records; cure/reversal; false acceptance/rejection.
Verify independent evidence	Confirm paper, ballot-accounting, custody, audit, and recount readiness before voting begins and before certification.	Accounting completion; custody exceptions; audit readiness; reconstructability test.
Reduce privileged/vendor exposure	Eliminate shared accounts, require MFA and least privilege, inventory remote access, validate software, and test log retention.	MFA/log coverage; remote sessions; hash/config variance; recovery time.
Exercise failure modes	Run manual-continuity, cyber, reporting, custody, and public-communication exercises using realistic deadlines.	Exercise completion; failed injects corrected; fallback staffing and supplies.
Publish indicator owners	Assign who receives, validates, escalates, and communicates each warning indicator.	Owner assigned; cadence; threshold; response path.
Separate incident from effect	Use reporting templates that identify evidence stage and prevent allegations, anomalies, or capability from being presented as counted-ballot effect.	Stage-coded reports; disposition closure; correction latency.

Decision-useful indicators

Priority indicators include unresolved eligibility conflicts, duplicate-active records, unusual ballot request/return/cure concentrations, shared credentials or disabled logs, hash mismatches, broken custody seals, unresolved unofficial-to-canvass variance, official impersonation, coordinated narrative onset after incidents, and foreign-source or shell-entity finance indicators. [C-01]

Implications, Caveats, and Baseline Effect

This section converts the judgments into direct implications for legislation, oversight, funding, and public confidence. Use it to test whether a proposal addresses the identified assurance gaps, creates measurable evidence, and avoids trading one integrity failure for another. The accompanying caveats and baseline-effect record state what the digest supports, what it contradicts, and what remains unresolved.

Decision area	Implication
For legislation	Focus on assurance outcomes, evidence preservation, reporting standards, audit readiness, fair eligibility validation, and technology/vendor controls. Avoid creating one inflexible operating model that breaks lawful state variation or special-case participation.
For oversight	Ask where each vector enters the lifecycle, what control prevents it, what evidence would reveal it, who reviews it, how fast it is resolved, and whether the outcome can be reconstructed independently.
For funding	Prioritize shared services, grants, templates, technology-hardening, audit capacity, workforce training, evidence repositories, incident reporting, and manual-continuity exercises for small and under-resourced jurisdictions.
For public confidence	Require authenticated public communication that separates incident, anomaly, control activation, and effect. Fast statements should be bounded; verified correction should be routine.

What this digest does not claim

This digest does not claim nationwide compromise of certified vote counts; a national fraud rate; a ranking of vectors by undetected prevalence; PRC alteration of ballots, tabulation, certification, or the 2020 result; or legal sufficiency of any proposed control without jurisdiction-specific review. [C-01; SP-01]

Baseline effect	Result
Reinforces	Election fraud, interference, administrative failure, cyber targeting, and influence activity are real risk classes; several pathways have been exploited.
Refines	The central national problem is uneven assurance and limited measurement across a decentralized system.
Contradicts	Anomaly totals, duplicate registrations, allegations, referrals, charges, and convictions cannot be combined into one national fraud rate.
Preserves	Warning and mitigation are justified without claiming broad compromise of certified counts.

SOURCE APPENDIX A - Source posture and controls

This appendix condenses the controlled source record in Source Packet 2026-02B. It is not a substitute for full source audit. Inclusion below does not imply adoption of every claim in a source. [SP-01]

Source class	Permitted use	Principal boundary
Official administrative sources	Used for national exposure, technology, audit, list-maintenance, provisional voting, federal-form, and procedural context.	Strong for bounded administrative measures; not proof of fraud, undetected activity, or control performance.
Official technical / consensus sources	Used for cyber, technology, paper, audit, and resilience logic.	Strong for control design; implementation and performance vary by jurisdiction.
Official foreign-influence sources	Used for tactics, threat actors, public influence, and malign activity patterns.	Public products do not reveal full intelligence basis, coverage, or effect measurement.
Judicial/prosecutorial records	Used for bounded event, offense, or disposition evidence.	Disposition is metadata; scale, coordination, and effect require separate evidence.
Investigative observation	Used for directly observed conduct when video/testimony and official action support a bounded proposition.	Not every observed actor or broader claim has a final public legal disposition.
Case repositories	Used for examples, within-dataset frequencies, and method discovery.	Purposive, not representative; mixed dispositions and uneven source depth.
Advocacy/commercial datasets	Used only as bounded discovery leads unless methods are transparent and replicable.	Opaque matching, source overlap, and missing error rates prevent national prevalence use.
Derivative aggregators	Used as falsification targets or examples of unsupported aggregation.	Rejected for substantive quantitative use when claim-level sourcing fails.

Source rule

Repetition is not corroboration. Sources sharing the same author, dataset, investigation, reporting chain, official product, or claim stream remain one evidence stream unless independent support is demonstrated. [SP-01]

SOURCE APPENDIX B - Selected source register

The selected register below identifies the sources carrying the greatest decision weight in this digest and the principal limitation governing each use. It is a navigation aid to the full Source Packet 2026-02B, not a replacement for source-level audit and deconfliction.

ID	Source	Primary use	Main limitation
C-01	Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02	Companion assessment; source of the principal judgments, 15 vectors, metrics, recommendations, assumptions, and review requirements.	Draft; not approved; requires source, legal, technical, tradecraft, red-team, and release review.
SP-01	Source Packet 2026-02B	Controlled evidentiary record, source dispositions, deconfliction, rejected/quarantined claims, data transformations.	Complete for material current-draft sources, not every possible U.S. case or source.
PSR-01	Process Summary Report 2026-02A	Executed pathway, methods, baseline changes, review status, and production history.	Documents process; does not certify substantive source accuracy.
EAC-01	2024 Election Administration and Voting Survey	National administrative exposure measures: registration, voting methods, workforce, technology, cure/rejection, paper coverage.	Certified submissions; definitions and completeness vary; not fraud incidence.
EAC-02/03	Election audit resources and draft audit standards	Audit variation and movement toward common voluntary audit principles.	Not proof of universal adoption or performance.
EAC-04/05/07	VVSG, paper-system resources, technology best practices	Certification generations, paper-record coverage, hash validation, logs, unique credentials, two-person control, custody, continuity.	Voluntary or guidance unless adopted; implementation unmeasured.
EAC-06/08/09/10	Voter lists, provisional voting, federal law overview, registration form	Registration, list maintenance, provisional path, federal form, and legal context.	Does not replace state law or legal review.
NIST-01	Election Infrastructure Cybersecurity Profile	Cyber-risk management across voter registration, voting systems, supporting technology, and service providers.	Framework guidance; maturity varies.
NAS-01	Securing the Vote	Human-readable paper ballots, independent evidence, risk-limiting audits, resilience logic.	Foundational; not a current implementation census.
FMI-01/02	CISA/FBI/ODNI and ODNI FMI products	Foreign malign influence tactics, impersonation, synthetic content, information manipulation, post-voting targeting.	Public-level source basis; effect measurement opaque.
DOJ-01/02/03/04	DOJ election-crime, Armstrong case, NVRA guidance and cases	Election offense categories; bounded paid-registration/false-address conduct; legal context.	Not a national prevalence dataset or legal opinion.
DB-01 / OK-01	Heritage export and O'Keefe testimony/video stream	Bounded case-discovery corpus; directly observed conduct and official corroboration for selected conduct.	Not nationally representative; not every observed claim finally adjudicated.

SOURCE APPENDIX C - Review status and release conditions

The following review record identifies the minimum coordination and approval work required before external release or reliance as an approved Tornberg Consulting product. It separates current analytic usefulness from formal review and publication status.

Review	Minimum requirement
Source audit	Verify every material quantitative claim, source ID, quotation, case disposition, URL, source independence, definition, and limitation. Reconcile digest with Source Packet 2026-02B.
Legal review	Assess NVRA, HAVA, UOCAVA, Voting Rights Act, privacy, federalism, state-law, procurement, funding, and legislative-authority implications.
Technical review	Validate cybersecurity, voting systems, pollbooks, audits, logging, vendors, custody, paper evidence, and continuity statements with qualified specialists.
Tradecraft review	Test evidence-stage separation, confidence, alternatives, detectability, source dependence, metric validity, and recommendation traceability.
Red-team review	Challenge the uneven-assurance framing, selected vector priorities, risk of improper exclusion, risk of centralized common-mode failure, and actionability of recommendations.
Approval authority	An accountable senior professional must approve the source packet, digest, recommendations, handling, audience, and release version before external use.
Final status DRAFT FOR REVIEW, COORDINATION, AND REVISION. This digest is a condensed decision-support expression of the companion assessment. It must not be represented as an approved Tornberg Consulting product, government assessment, legal opinion, or final client-facing intelligence product before accountable review and release authorization.	

Digest conclusion: The United States does not need proof of nationwide compromise before addressing demonstrated pathways. It needs disciplined separation of what is known from what is warned, strong preventive assurance before active inputs, independent evidence after transactions, measurable controls, fair procedures for exceptional cases, and a national ability to identify, contain, explain, and correct failure. [C-01]